

KELROY JAMES

Supply Chain Assurance | Third-Party Risk | Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

GRC and supply chain assurance specialist with 18 years of Defence logistics experience, targeting third-party risk, GRC consulting and internal audit roles at professional services firms and banks, and supply chain assurance, export control or trade compliance roles at defence primes. Track record of closing the gap between records and physical reality through systematic controls, risk-based auditing and enterprise-level process improvement, with £2.7M+ in quantified business impact.

Core Skills: Third-Party Risk Management | Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) | Internal Audit & Risk-Based Auditing | Supply Chain Assurance | ISO/IEC 27001, 42001, 27701 | COSO Internal Control Framework | Three Lines Model | Export Control & Trade Compliance (ITAR, EAR) | Dangerous Goods Compliance (IMDG Code, ADR, IATA DGR) | Financial Control & Root Cause Analysis | Digital Transformation (Palantir Foundry) | Data Analytics (SQL, Python, Power BI) | PRINCE2 Project Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Petty Officer (Supply Chain Manager)

Royal Navy, Type 45 Destroyer | May 2024 – Present

- Took over an account graded unsatisfactory at Fleet Logistics Inspection; identified and corrected £2.4M in misallocated expenditure through systematic financial control analysis, restoring full compliance within 12 months and triggering a Navy-wide policy instruction to prevent recurrence
- Co-developed the STOROB inventory interrogation application in Palantir Foundry with BAE Systems and DE&S, delivering enterprise-grade data validation and real-time visibility scoped for fleet-wide rollout
- Ranked in the top 3 of 79 peer supply chain senior rates across Surface Flotilla HQ; reduced financial liability by 80% through asset verification and documentation remediation
- Founded "Empowerment Day" within Engineering Support Group 1 to build junior rates' self-awareness and career development, adopted as a standing programme

Petty Officer (Stores Office Manager)

Royal Navy, Wildcat Maritime Force | Apr 2022 – May 2024

- Consolidated dispersed Force Mobile Equipment into a single accountable stock holding site, closing 14 major loss investigations
- Led a team of 7 through the unit's Gibraltar weapons trial and Exercise Tamber Shield deployments, turning round a rejected consignment in 3 days for a trial valued at approximately £5M and recovering a mid-exercise equipment shortfall with 3 hours to spare; recognised with the Royal Navy Inclusivity Award for Innovation (2023)
- Completed a strategic innovation course and introduced Mission Model Canvas training to build the team's strategic awareness of innovation; 5 of 7 team members have since been promoted

Section Head, Supply Chain (Petty Officer)

Royal Navy, Surface Flotilla Engineering Support (WLSG) | Jun 2021 – Apr 2022

- Took on Section Head responsibilities immediately upon promotion to Petty Officer, delivering Tier 1 Compliance Management Tool assurance across the Type 45, Type 23 and Hunt-class mine countermeasures fleets
- Selected for the Percy Hobart Innovation Fellowship, a 12-week digital transformation programme, developing a project on sustainable consignment tracking

Leading Hand (Supply Chain)

Royal Navy, HMS Defender (Type 45 Destroyer) | Mar 2020 – Nov 2020

- Deputised for the Section Head across the ship's Naval Stores Account throughout an intensive pre-deployment training work-up, maintaining full compliance under sustained operational pressure
- Coordinated a de-ammunitioning evolution with Royal Navy and MOD stakeholders and no senior-rate oversight, delivering it safely ahead of a fleet exercise

Leading Hand, Fleet Stores Coordination Cell

Royal Navy, Fleet Operations (Maritime Operations Centre) | Jul 2018 – Mar 2020

- Provided 24/7 watchkeeping cover for Fleet-wide operational-defect logistics, sustaining concurrent support to a carrier strike group deployment, a major Middle East exercise and a NATO High North exercise
- Rated the strongest of more than 10 Leading Hands across two reporting periods; selected to understudy the Petty Officer billet

Leading Hand (Supply Chain Supervisor)

Royal Navy, Fleet Diving Squadron HQ | Dec 2016 – Jul 2018

- Sole logistician for Fleet Diving Squadron's Portsmouth-based units; designed and delivered an organic, PRINCE2-governed consignment tracking capability, eliminating a 200-mile round-trip dependency and sustaining exercises across 4 nations
- Concurrently performed Warrant-Officer-level movements officer duties; awarded the Chief Naval Logistics Officer's Award for coaching and mentoring (2018)

Supply Chain Specialist / Logistics Inspector

Royal Navy, Various Postings | 2008 – 2016

- Sole logistics point of contact for a Joint Forces Logistics Unit in the Falkland Islands, managing a £30K monthly Government Procurement Card budget and cutting low-value purchase orders by 80%
- Restructured Ministry of Defence inventory accounting (MJDl) across 31 NATO locations while posted to the European Joint Support Unit at SHAPE, Belgium
- Delivered a £250K cost-saving lean maintenance initiative through inventory optimization and stock-holding reduction

GIS Analyst & Infrastructure Planner

St Vincent Electricity Services | 1996 – 2008

- Led GPS geo-tagging of national grid infrastructure (12,000+ assets), underpinning an Esri Special Achievement in GIS Award-winning enterprise mapping system
- Advanced from meter reader to planning specialist through self-directed capability development; awarded Employee of the Year for operational excellence

EDUCATION

- MSc Supply Chain and Logistics Management (Defence Logistics Staff Course), University of Lincoln — In Progress (Distinction track), Apr 2025 – Apr 2027; route to MCIPS, eligible for CMILT on transition
- MicroMasters, Supply Chain Management & Advanced Network Design, MIT Center for Transportation & Logistics — Completed 2024
- Professional Award in Cyber Security & OSINT, Abertay University — Distinction, 2023–2025

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 / 42001:2023 / 27701:2025 Lead Auditor; Fellow of Management Systems Auditing (FellowMSA) — Mastermind
- CompTIA PenTest+ ce
- Forward Program (Advanced Professional Development), McKinsey & Company — 2024
- 1SL Richmond Fellowship, Royal Navy Strategic Studies Centre — 2025–2026

Full certification record and continuing education: kelroyjames.com/skills-expertise.html

PUBLISHED FRAMEWORKS

OSINT Supplier Verification Framework | Same Control, Two Vocabularies | The Three Lines of Defence: From Warships to AI | Change Management in a Rank Hierarchy — full case studies at kelroyjames.com

AWARDS

- Royal Navy Inclusivity Award for Innovation — 2023, Wildcat Maritime Force, for leading a 7-person team through operational deployments
- Chief Naval Logistics Officer's Award — 2018, Coaching, Mentoring & Training
- Herbert Lott Naval Trust Fund Efficiency Award — 2019, process improvement and operational excellence

Portfolio with full case studies, published frameworks and case-study evidence for every metric above: kelroyjames.com
Available now for advisory conversations and professional networking while serving. Available for full-time roles from April 2028 (resettlement).
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